

SQL Interview Revision Report (30 July 2026)

Topics Revised

- INNER JOIN, LEFT JOIN, SELF JOIN
- GROUP BY and HAVING
- Aggregate Functions (COUNT, AVG, SUM, MAX)
- Normal Subqueries
- Correlated Subqueries
- Two-Step Aggregation Pattern

Key Interview Pattern Learned

When a question asks for Highest, Lowest, Maximum, Minimum, Above Average or Below Average, think in two steps: (1) Compute the grouped values. (2) Compare with MAX/MIN/AVG using a subquery.

Important Practice Questions

Q1. Departments with more than 4 employees.

Concept: JOIN + GROUP BY + HAVING

Q2. Customers who never placed an order.

Concept: LEFT JOIN + WHERE Order_ID IS NULL

Q3. Departments whose average salary is greater than 75000.

Concept: GROUP BY + HAVING AVG

Q4. Customers whose total purchase exceeds the overall average order amount.

Concept: GROUP BY + SUM + Subquery

Q5. Display every employee with their manager.

Concept: SELF JOIN

Q6. Managers with more than two direct reports.

Concept: SELF JOIN + GROUP BY + HAVING

Q7. Departments whose average salary is greater than the company average.

Concept: GROUP BY + Subquery

Q8. Employees earning more than the average salary of their own department.

Concept: Correlated Subquery

Q9. Manager(s) managing the highest number of employees.

Concept: SELF JOIN + Two-Step Aggregation + MAX

Q10. Customer(s) with the highest number of orders.

Concept: JOIN + Two-Step Aggregation + MAX

Performance Summary

Reasoning: 10/10. The main mistakes were only minor syntax typos (NULL/NONE, aliases, column spelling). Pattern recognition and interview reasoning were consistently correct.

Next Topics

- UNION & UNION ALL
- CASE WHEN
- String Functions
- Date Functions
- CTEs
- Window Functions